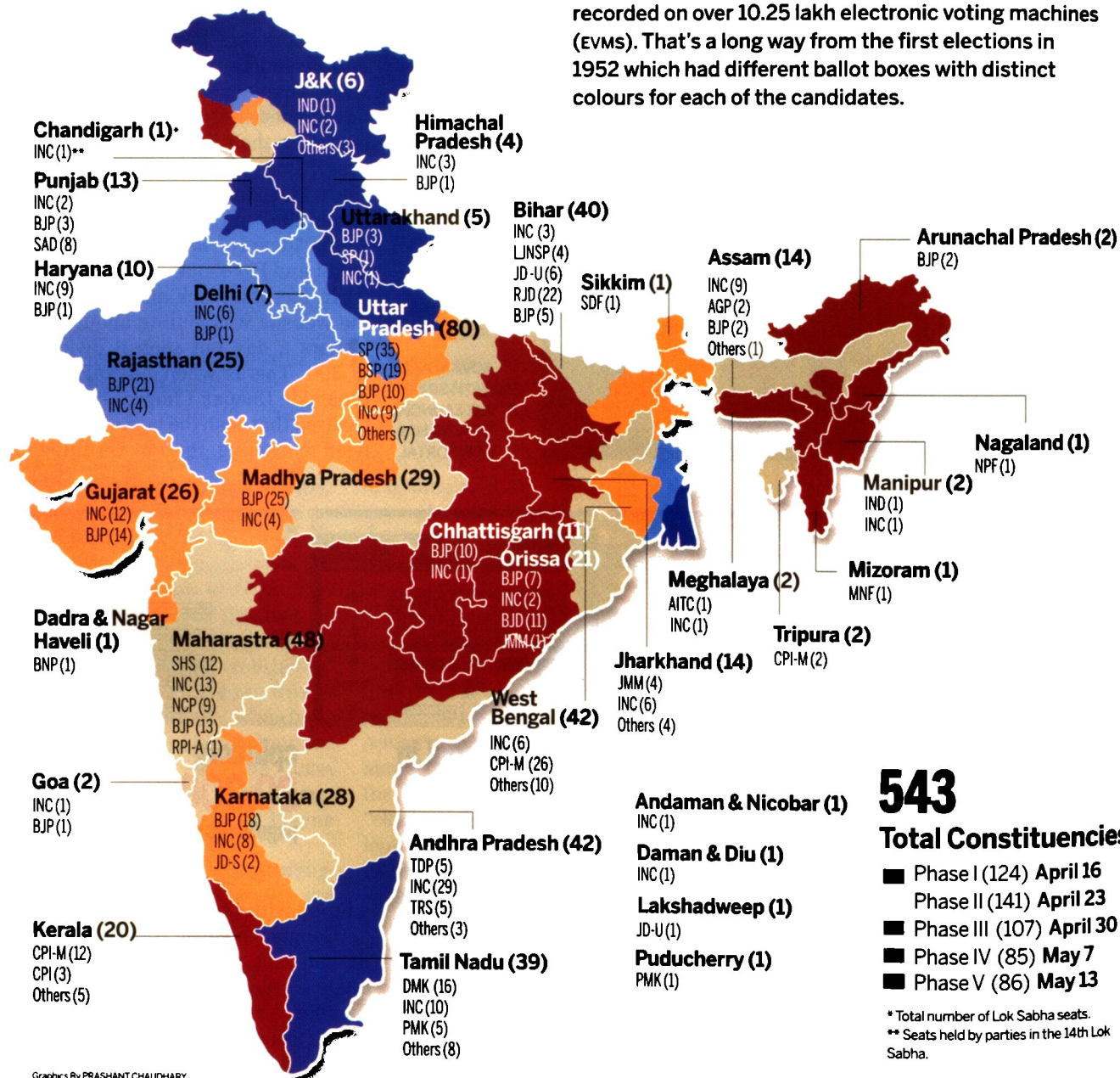


Order of BATTLE

In exactly a month from now, the world's largest democracy will get energised once again as one-sixth of the world's population queues up at polling booths across the country. More than 70 crore voters will exercise their franchise to choose 543 representatives to the 15th Lok Sabha. The votes will be cast at more than eight lakh polling centres where they will be recorded on over 10.25 lakh electronic voting machines (EVMs). That's a long way from the first elections in 1952 which had different ballot boxes with distinct colours for each of the candidates.



40 lakh civilian employees and over 21 lakh personnel of various security and state police forces will be deployed during the five-phase poll.